MARYLEBONE ROSTER · LINKS DESIGNER · AT A GLANCE

# New CEA link proposals — at a glance



All 19 proposals against today's link — the three shortlisted ones marked ★, and the five where 14 days' leave buys 30 days off, as today, marked so — sorted by December rules met, then avoidable fatigue warnings, then by name; a proposal that breaks a hard limit cannot be run as it stands and comes last. Every figure is worked out from the rota, by the Marylebone Roster app's own checks and the tooling beside them. Staffing levels and Sunday cover confirmed verbally (29 Sep 2026); the 26-line link, 5 cover weeks and a ceiling of 219 contracted days a year set on 1 Oct 2026.

Prepared 6 Nov 2026 · every figure is computed from the rotas

| PROPOSAL · CODE | DECEMBER RULES MET | AVOIDABLE FATIGUE WARNINGS§ | MOST DAYS IN A ROW§ | FULL WEEKENDS OFF | SHORTEST REST BETWEEN SHIFTS§ | SHIFT TIMES | DAYS A YEAR* | HEAVIEST WEEK, MON–SAT | WEEKS ON ONE SHIFT TIME, ALL EARLIES OR ALL LATES | WEEKS MIXING EARLIES AND LATES | WEEK-TO-WEEK CHANGE OF START | FINISHES 23:00+ A YEAR† |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Today's link** 20 weeks | 4 of 9 | 4<br>up to 5§ | 7<br>up to 9§ | 4 in 20<br>about 10 a year · 7 weeks apart at most | 12h 30m | 18 | 219.0 | 43h 50m | 7 of 16<br>blocks 2 (up to 3) | 7 | 4h 00m | 39 |
| **Both Ways** BW-26-T3 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m | 15 (6 new) | 218.6 | 41h 20m | 16 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 40m | 42 |
| **Clean Slate** CS-26-N2 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 16 (10 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 19 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 21m | 42 |
| **Closing Time** CT-26-T2 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 13 (6 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 17 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 10m | 42 |
| **Common Ground** CG-26-T8<br>**★ shortlisted**<br>**30 days off for 14 days' leave** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 13 (6 new) | 218.6 | 42h 30m | 19 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 12m | 42 |
| **Even Keel** EK-26-H1 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 14 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 12) | 1 | 1h 16m | 44 |
| **Even Step** ES-26-T5<br>**★ shortlisted** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 13 (6 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 31m | 42 |
| **Fair Share** FS-26-T7 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 16 (9 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 18m | 42 |
| **Fine Tune** FT-26-H1 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 14 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 16 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 12) | 1 | 1h 09m | 44 |
| **Grand Tour** GT-26-T7<br>**30 days off for 14 days' leave** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 16 (9 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 16 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 16m | 42 |
| **Home Grown** HG-26-T1 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 13 (4 new) | 218.6 | 42h 30m | 16 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 25m | 42 |
| **In Step** IS-26-T4 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 15 (7 new) | 218.6 | 41h 05m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 13m | 42 |
| **Long Break** LB-26-F1 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 6<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m | 15 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 16 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 9) | 0 | 1h 44m | 42 |
| **Middle Ground** MG-26-T8<br>**30 days off for 14 days' leave** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 13 (6 new) | 218.6 | 42h 30m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 41m | 42 |
| **Next Step** NS-26-T6 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 35m | 14 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 18m | 42 |
| **Open Return** OR-26-EXT<br>**30 days off for 14 days' leave** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 0§ | 5<br>up to 6§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 13h 15m | 16 (9 new) | 218.6 | 43h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 17m | 42 |
| **Second Edition** SE-26-F1 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 6<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m | 15 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 01m | 42 |
| **Second Look** SL-26-G3 | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 0§ | 6<br>up to 6§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m | 14 (7 new) | 218.6 | 43h 40m | 15 of 21<br>blocks 4 (up to 6) | 1 | 1h 30m | 42 |
| **Short Openers** SO-26-EXT<br>**30 days off for 14 days' leave** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 0§ | 5<br>up to 6§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 13h 15m | 14 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 00m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 12m | 42 |
| **Short Run** SR-26-F1<br>**★ shortlisted** | **9 of 9** | **0**<br>up to 1§ | 5<br>up to 7§ | 7 in 26<br>about 14 a year · 5 weeks apart at most | 14h 20m | 15 (7 new) | 218.6 | 42h 30m | 18 of 21<br>blocks 5 (up to 7) | 0 | 1h 13m | 42 |

* Monday to Saturday, with a cover week counted as 4 days (Sundays are overtime and left out). † Each person, on average across the whole link, Sundays included; cover-week duties are not known yet and are left out. "Shift times" counts different start–finish times; "new" means nobody works that time today.

"Weeks on one shift time" means one shift time Monday to Friday, all earlies or all lates; beneath it, the longest block of weeks in a row on one kind, "up to" if the cover weeks beside it go the same way. The week-to-week change is the average move of the start time from one week to the next.

§ On the duties the rota fixes, the cover weeks left out for the proposal and today alike; "up to" is the worst place a cover week's four duties could fall, its Sunday worked as overtime. Avoidable fatigue warnings come from the ORR's good-practice list plus rail-industry checks, leaving out the two that come with the station and the link — the 06:20 open and a weekly rotation — and are reported, never pass or fail.

Full detail for each proposal is in its own eight-page sheet; the rules themselves are in links-26-rules.pdf.